

ART AND CULTURE



RELIGION AND PHILOSOPHY

- RELIGION OF ISLAM
- SUFI MOVEMENT

MODULE – 13



ISLAM



- 1 The Islamic religion has the **second largest** following in the world (1.7 billion followers).

- 2 It has its origin in the teachings of **Quran** revealed by God (Allah) to the **Prophet Muhammad** (570 CE to 632 CE) who is also considered the **last Prophet of the God**.
- 3 The religion had its origin in **Mecca** in the **7th century CE**.
- 4 By the 8th century it had spread to the entire Arabian peninsula from the Iberian peninsula in the west (covering Portugal and Spain) to the Indus river in the east.

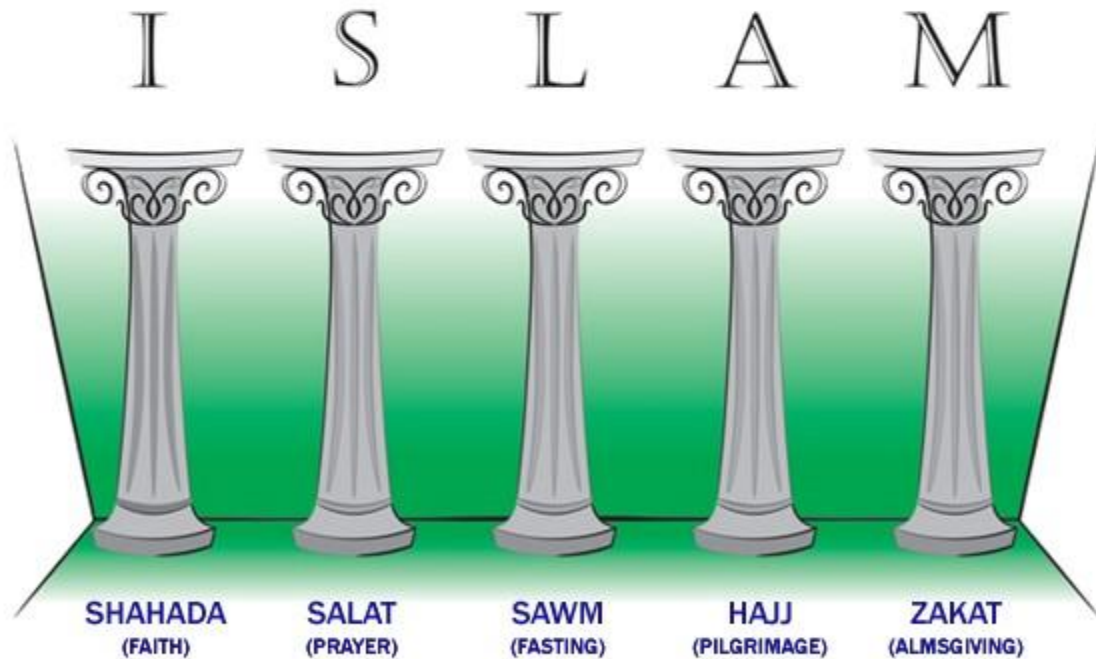
ISLAM

ISLAMIC FAITH & FUNDAMENTAL BELIEFS

- 1** Islam is a **monotheistic religion** which believes in only one God or Allah (the incomparable one) with Prophet Muhammad as his last messenger.
- 2** It advocates **universal brotherhood, love, and equality of mankind**; as key tenets of Islamic teachings and **prohibits idolism and deity worship**.
- 3** Islam **also believes in earlier Prophets, viz. Abraham, Moses, and Jesus** but believes that Prophet Muhammad was the last messenger or Prophet of God.
- 4** It believes in the faith that the world will come to an end on the **Last Day or the Qiyamah**, when everybody will be accountable for their deeds.

ISLAM

ISLAMIC FAITH & FUNDAMENTAL BELIEFS



5

The five pillars of Islam are at the core of Islamic religious beliefs. These include:

- **Shahda** – or belief in one God or Allah with Muhammad as his messenger and the last Prophet.
- **Namaz or Salah** - or offering of prayer to the God five times a day.
- **Roza** – keeping of compulsory fast in the holy month of Ramadan.
- **Zakat** – the practice of charitable giving based on accumulated wealth.
- **Hajj** – to take the pilgrimage to Mecca once in a person's lifetime for those who can afford to do so physically as well as financially.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

ISLAM

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN HAJ AND UMRAH



- 1 Haj Islamic pilgrimage to Mecca in Saudi Arabia is one of the largest pilgrimages in the world. The Haj is a demonstration of the solidarity of the Muslim people, and their submission to Allah.

- 2 Haj is one of the five tenets of Islam. It's every Muslim's desire to perform Haj at least once in his life time.
- 3 It is not necessary that Mecca can be visited by Muslims at the time of Haj only. Umrah is a pilgrimage to Mecca performed by Muslims that can be undertaken at any time of the year.
- 4 So, Umrah is called a 'minor pilgrimage' or 'lesser pilgrimage', the Haj being the 'major' pilgrimage.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

ISLAM

HAJ COMMITTEE OF INDIA

- 1 Haj Committee of India is a statutory body constituted under the **Haj Committee Act 2002** which organises Islamic pilgrimages to Saudi Arabia.



حج کمیٹی آف انڈیا

HAJ COMMITTEE OF INDIA

- 2 It is empowered to make arrangements for the Indian Pilgrims only in India under the present norms.
- 3 On reaching Jeddah / Madinah airport the responsibility to look after the Pilgrims and to redress their grievances is that of the **Indian Consulate stationed at Jeddah**.
- 4 Haj Committee of India is committed to monitor the facilities made available to the Pilgrims.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

ISLAM

SCRIPTURES IN ISLAM



- 1 The Islamic faith is based on the **Holy Quran** which is believed to contain the revelations of God to the Prophet Muhammad.

- 2 It contains 114 chapters or Surahs which cover varied subjects.
- 3 The next important source of Islamic belief is the **Hadith or the Sunnah**.
- 4 These are the **traditions of the Prophet** as to what he did or said or approved **regarding various subjects**, which were compiled by his companions.
- 5 Thus, Sunnah plays an important role in the interpretation of the Quran.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

ISLAM

SECTS IN ISLAM

The Shias and the Sunnis are the two main sects of Muslims with the **Sunnis comprising the majority (85%)**. In recent years, Sunni-Shia relations have been increasingly marked by conflict particularly the **Iran-Saudi Arabia proxy conflict**.

SHIA SECT

- The Shias consider **Ali who was the Son-in-law of Prophet Muhammad as the rightful Khalifah (Caliph)**.
- Therefore, they do not believe in **Abu Bakr, Umar, and Usman** who were the first three Caliphs in which the Sunnis believe.
- The followers became known as Shias, a contraction of the phrase Shiat Ali, or followers of Ali.

SUNNI SECT

- The Sunnis, however, regard the first three caliphs before Ali as rightly guided and themselves as **the true adherents to the Sunnah, or the Prophet's tradition**.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

ISLAM

ISLAM IN INDIA

- 1 Islam is believed to have first come to India in the 6th century CE along with the Arab traders who came to the Malabar coast.
- 2 Islam also spread to Sindh and parts of Gujarat through the Arabic traders.
- 3 Local population in the Malabar coast that embraced Islam were social and cultural group known as the Moplas.
- 4 However, large scale Islamic influence and presence only happened after the Turkish invasion and establishment of the Delhi Sultanate in the 12th century CE.
- 5 With the establishment of the Mughal dynasty in the 16th century in large parts of India, Islamic influence too spread in India.
- 6 Today, there are 172 million Muslims in India (2011 Census) and constitute the second largest religious group after the Hindus.
- 7 The Indian Muslims are largely the followers of Hanafi Madhab which is one of the four Sunni Orthodox schools. Some Muslims in Kerala are also the followers of the Shafi Madhab.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

THE SUFI MOVEMENT

ORIGIN

- 1 Sufism or tasawwuf, as it is called in Arabic, is a inner, mystical, or psycho-spiritual dimension of Islam
- 2 Teachings of Prophet Mohammad attracted a group of scholars who came to be called “Ahle Suffe”, sitting at the platform of the mosque of the Prophet in Medina.
- 3 There they engaged themselves in discussions concerning the reality of ‘Being’, and in search of the inner path and devoted themselves to spiritual purification and meditation. These individuals were the founders of Sufism.
- 4 Sufis represented the inner side of the Islamic creed, which stresses on self-realisation, beautification of the soul through piety, righteousness and universal love for all.
- 5 In India, Sufism helped in maintaining communal harmony and social stability by advocating religious tolerance and by borrowing spiritual techniques and practices from other religions.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

THE SUFI MOVEMENT

ORIGIN



6 The **longevity of the Sufi traditions** in India can be understood by the fact that **people still frequently visit the dargahs** looking for cure from ailments or personal problems.

7 The Sufi lyrics are all the rage in today's **popular Hindi music** and the dervishes and fakirs still form a part of our ideas of charity and a life of selflessness.

8 In very amateur terms Sufism is a kind of mystical philosophy.

9 The word finds its roots in Arabic word for **wool (suf)**, indicative of the **garments of rough wool worn by the ascetics and even the prophets**.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

THE SUFI MOVEMENT

ORIGIN

WHAT IS THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN A MOSQUE AND DARGAH?

- *Mosque, the house of Allah, is erected locally for Islam for the habitual ritual prayer of 5 times (daily salah- the religious prayer)*
- *Dargah is a shrine built over the grave of a revered religious figure, often a Sufi saint*

10 The literature produced from the 10th century helps us to understand the socio-cultural scenario of medieval India.

11 The social context of Sufism is expressed in the Sufi orders, many institutions formed around the saint's tomb like the Dargah.

12 In India, one of the first Sufi shrines belonged to Shaikh Farid-al-Din Ganj-I Shankar (A.D. 1265) known popularly as Baba Farid. His shrine lies in Ajudhan/Pakpattan town.

13 As Baba Farid wrote in Punjabi, he was the prime candidate to consider for indigenization and spread of Sufism in Punjab.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

THE SUFI MOVEMENT

CHARACTERISTICS

According to some historians, there are three stages in the history of Sufism:

STAGE	PERIOD	CHARACTER
1 st Stage : Khanqah	10 th century	Also called the age of Golden Mysticism.
2 nd Stage : Tariqa	11-14 th century	When Sufism was being institutionalized and traditions and symbols started being attached to it.
3 rd Stage : Tarifa	15 th century	The stage when Sufism became a popular movement.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

THE SUFI MOVEMENT

CHARACTERISTICS

- 1 The lands which were the abode of war after coming under the Sufi's spiritual authority and the king's political authority became the **land of peace (Dar-al Islam)**.



- 2 The basic tenants of Sufism included the **concept of 'Purity'**.
- 3 Sufism became the process of **purification of hearts which means a rigorous ethical discipline**.
- 4 The basic point in the Sufic philosophy is the **primacy of the inner reality and believing that God was the first, the last and the outer and the inner components of every entity**.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

THE SUFI MOVEMENT

CHARACTERISTICS



The sufi whirling dervishes seen in pic

- 5 Most Sufis use the vocabulary of love and intimate affection while describing their experience with god.

- 6 It was a badge of honour for the Sufi to be known as the lover of god or of their Sufi masters.

- 7 They were even called 'ahl-I dil or master of the heart'.

- 8 The Sufi Khanqah was not without its hierarchies.

- 9 The Sufi saints had obtained **wilaya** or the Islamic doctrine of sainthood, which made him close to God and was protected by the grace of God.

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

THE SUFI MOVEMENT

CHARACTERISTICS



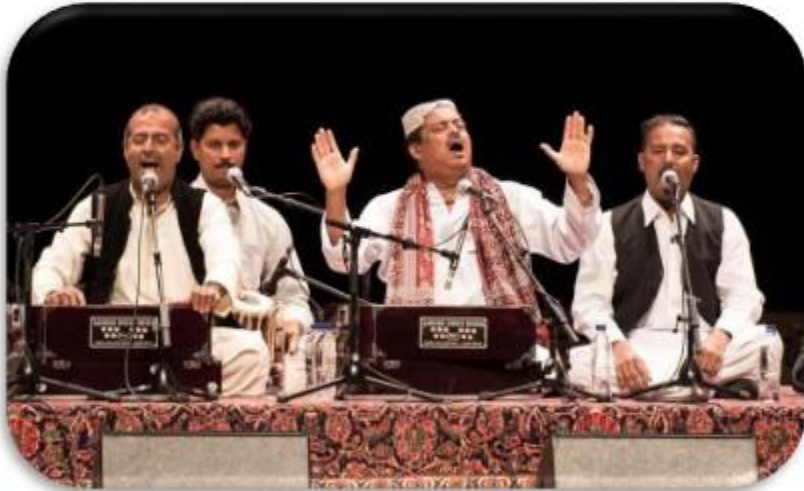
- 10 There are many terms for the teacher and guide like **pir or sheikh** whose main task was to transmit the **teachings to the student, i.e. the murid.**
- 11 Chief disciples are chosen to act as the **successor (khalifa) or representative (muqaddam) of the master.**
- 12 There was an unspoken and invisible **spiritual and territorial authority of the saints.**

RELIGIONS IN MODERN INDIA

THE SUFI MOVEMENT

CHARACTERISTICS

SAMA



- 13** The musical and ecstatic aspect of Sufism is called Sama



RUMI

- 14** This is a particular kind of devotional dance akin to Kirtana and was introduced by Jalaluddin Rumi.
- 15** With particular movements and often special and rhythmical music, he engages in the selfless remembrance of God.
- 16** The Sama poetry is mostly sung in the form of **Qawwali**. Music of Sama is set within metric framework, accompanied by **Dholak, Tabla, Sarangi, Harmonium and Sitar**.

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